strong

technological y, over the past few centuries, have wrested control, for their own purposes. These major powers have become the self-proclaimed leaders of the new world order. What does a country of one bil ion people, like India, do in such a situation? We have no other option but to be technological y strong. But, can India be a leader in the field of technology? My answer is an emphatic ‘Yes’. And let me validate my answer by narrating some incidents from my life.

When I first began the reminiscences that have gone into this book, I was uncertain about which of my memories were worth narrating or were of any relevance at al . My childhood is precious to me, but would it be of interest to anyone else? Was it worth the reader’s while, I wondered, to know about the tribulations and triumphs of a smal town boy? Of the straitened circumstances of my schooldays, the odd jobs I did to pay my school fees, and how my decision to become a vegetarian was partly due to my financial

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constraints as a col ege student—why should these be of any interest to the general public? In the end, I was